

codename SeaM

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# A LONG LONG TIME AGO

## SCENE 0: THUNDERSTORM DOWN SOUTH

Flashes of a thunderstorm - Flashes of a mother playing with her son - buildings and bird houses - - flashes of wind hitting the breeze upon the mountain fog - and flashes of a packed car and a vacation up north and to the east - from the barren west towards New England - flashes of a seaside beach town - flashes of a big thunderstorm - flashes of mom and dad getting gas - driving doing errands - flashes of Dallas setting up an weather device - flashes of a smile - flashes of a young boy in his mother's arms - flashes of a soft embrace - flashes of the hand on her shoulder from the warmth of her husband - flashes of chemo - flashes of weather instrument - flashes of experimental procedures in the garage and pointing it towards the sky - flashes of Dallas and his wife putting up a bird house - flashes of the mother pressing record on a tape and teaching young Mac how her voice sounds- flashes of the mom marveling at a baby bird - flashes of Mac helping him - flashes of the woods - flashes of green eyes in the tall grass - flashes of the dark grass - flashes of the mother coming back and running away from the dog - towards the light - flashes of a mother holding on to a bird house - sick - as she watches the birds flutter - she smiles - flashes of the darkness - flashes - of Dallas trying to shine lasers into the mirrors - and then the refractions into the eyes of the mom - but leaving the mom hopeless and flashes of Dallas holding young mac alone in a hospital waiting room - of the tall-grass and green eyes that sparkle like fireflies.

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# SATURDAY

SCENE 1: EXT. WINDY SEASIDE ROAD - DAY

DALLAS (40s) and his son MAC (10) drive along a winding seaside road. The rugged coastline stretches beside them, with Atlantic waves crashing against the rocks. A storm brews in the distance, dark clouds gather on the horizon.

As they drive the radio is on and the newscaster is almost excited to announce that there is a storm coming and that we are about to enter hurricane season.

SCENE 2: EXT. NEW HOUSE - SOUTHERN CONNECTICUT COAST - DAY

\_Dallas\_ signs papers on a clipboard handed to him by a \_MOVER\_. The Movers begin moving various boxes and furniture including a large wooden piano from the back of the truck.

In the distance - a man chases a small dog down the street. The news crew temporarily all turn their attention to the commotion - but quickly go back to their camera work.

Nearby across the street from the house - outside the nature preserve with the tall grass - , a \_TV CAMERAMAN\_ and a \_CAMERA CREW\_ capture a \_REPORTER\_ speaking into the camera. \_Mac\_ watches from a distance, curious and uncertain about the commotion.

SCENE 3: EXT. NEW HOUSE - DRIVEWAY - DAY

\_Dallas\_ and \_Mac\_ unload various items from a bucket in the back of their sedan. Dallas stands over the bucket and the items are an unfinished bird feeder and gardening tools.

\_Dallas\_ pauses, staring somberly at the bucket. His emotions overwhelm for a moment. Mac noticing this takes the bucket and walks away.

Mac from the back of the truck grabs his bike and examines it for damages. He brings it on the side of the house.

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SCENE 4: INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - DUSK

Mac and Dallas walk around the empty house and examine all of the properties and begin to unpack boxes and what not .

\_Mac\_ stands by the window, gazing out at the fading sunset as it dims the outdoor light around him. As the wind sways the branches, the fireflies' lights resemble the glint of eyes peering from the darkness.\_

\_Mac\_ glances up at the sky - a late autumn night, clear with some weather coming in from the west.\_

\_A WHIMPERING SOUND ECHOS FROM A DISTANCE.\_

SCENE 5: INT. MAC AND DALLAS KITCHEN - DINNERTIME - NIGHT

Dallas carefully plates an avocado, an onion, and a sliced lemon—meticulously into small pieces and then reassembled to appear untouched. His movements are deliberate, almost ritualistic.

Mac plays the piano for a bit and a bit haphazardly - he uses a cassette audio capture tape - and rewinds as he attempts another go at the song he was working on.

Dallas comes in with the food and places it on the coffee table - Mac scoots over. They flip on the channels and finds the weather channel.

ON TV : The same REPORTER from earlier, standing outside their house, discusses the unpredictable weather this time of year.

TV REPORTER

As you can see behind me, new traffic is - we even have some new residents - despite the ominous weather forecast. Meteorologists are predicting an unusually severe storm system to hit our coast within the couple of weeks hours. That's right folks - we're in for a wild ride.

Dallas moves closer to the TV, his expression growing concerned as he listens to the report.\_

TV REPORTER (cont'd)

> Residents are advised to always be ready in case of a such an emergency - have a plan - stock up on the basics - essentials and prepare for potential power outages. Stay tuned for further updates on this developing situation.

Mac's eyes drift back to the window, where the wind has picked up, rustling the tall grass outside.\_

Mac walks over to the piano and grabs the tape recorder and positions it outside of the window.

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SCENE 6: INT. MAC'S ROOM - NIGHT

Thunder rumbles in the distance, and the wind causes the storm approaches.

Mac looks at all of his boxes - and his mostly empty room - he doesn't have much decorations but a small single bed and a nightstand by a window. Out of the box - he takes a picture out of a

Mac looks out the window but the recorder has stopped. Mac opens the device to look for the batteries and finds a single battery - but is suddenly startled by the sound of the tape recorder is making - it is playing irregularly - and then it stops again - suddenly a faint whimpering sound is heard out Mac's bedroom window - and the window shakes a bit.

FADE OUT

SCENE 7: INT. CHURCH - MORNING

The Elderly woman stands at the pulpit, addressing the congregation. The church is filled with attentive listeners, including DALLAS (40s) and MAC (10), sitting quietly in a pew.

ELDERLY WOMAN

> Today's old testament reading is from the Book of Isaiah, Chapter 5 Verse 5. God will stretch out over Edom the measuring line of chaos and the plumb line of desolation. Her nobles will have nothing there to be called a kingdom, all her princes will vanish away. Thorns will overrun her citadels, nettles and brambles her strongholds. She will become a haunt for jackals, a home for owls. Desert creatures will meet with hyenas, and wild goats will bleat to each other; there the night creatures will also lie down and find for themselves places of rest.

(MORE)

ELDERLY WOMAN (cont'd)

The owl will nest there and lay eggs,  
she will hatch them, and care for her  
young under the shadow of her wings;  
there also the falcons will gather,  
each with its mate.

## SCENE 8: EXT. CHURCH FRONT LAWN - AFTERNOON

The church bustles with activity as congregates gather  
around long tables with plastic plates and plastic cups of  
ice tea. Dallas and Mac stand awkwardly on line -  
progressing slowly.

DOMINIC (50s), noticing their discomfort, approaches them  
with a welcoming smile.

\*\*DOMINIC\*\*

Hey there, - hey (hey) - dont worry -  
im not cutting the line ha - but i  
mean i will if you let

\*\*DALLAS\*\*

Indiana.

\*\*DOMINIC\*\*

Indiana, huh? Never been - Well,  
welcome - Where are you living now?

\*\*DALLAS\*\*

> Branford.

DOMINIC'S FACE  
- LIGHTS UP. -

\*\*DOMINIC\*\*

> No way! I'm in Branford too! Names  
Dominic - Howdy - hey whose this big  
guy - yo Kid you meet my kids - Whats  
your name again ? Dallas what are you  
from Texas (snarls) hey hey big  
listen - We have a BBQ going on  
tomorrow for the three day weekend -  
you got off work right?

(MORE)

\*\*DOMINIC\*\* (cont'd)  
Bonnie told me you're some professor  
at Yale - i got a cousin who works at  
Yale - yeah big time - full health  
benefits - yeah he works the  
library - truthfully i don't know  
what the hell he does ha ha - okay  
let's get you a plate big guy .

Dallas nods politely, \_Dominic points toward a flier hanging  
on the fridge near the coffee machine. It reads: "23rd  
Annual Branford Harvest Sea Festival."

                  \*\*DOMINIC\*\* (cont'd)  
  
                  > Diego - yo Diego! - yeah - Diego,  
                  works there - some charity who the  
                  hell knows - we should go

Dallas listens politely, nodding along, but his attention  
drifts as the man continues to rattle on.\_

In the distance outside by the playground, \_Makayla and  
Asher hover around an object - Makayla looks around and  
signals Asher to put it in a backpack - Mac sees from the  
distance - but doesn't say anything.\_

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#### SCENE 9: EXT. BRANFORD STREETS - EARLY EVENING

Dallas and Mac\_ walk home from church. The journey is a bit  
of a hike. They pass through the tall beech grass, a little  
pizzeria, a small post office, a free library mail post, and  
a mix of nice homes with boats docked nearby--some pristine,  
others not so much.

Mac Records sounds

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#### SCENE 10: EXT. MAC AND DALLAS HOUSE - BUTTERFLY LANE

They continue past it all, into their corner of the world--a quiet cul-de-sac near a land preserve and a bird sanctuary.

They finally arrive home, exhausted, taking in the sight of their new house as the wind begins to pick up and the clouds begin to gather.

Mac and Dallas look around at the property - and the property looks back at them.

SCENE 10 A: EXT. MAC AND DALLAS HOUSE - BACKYARD - SUNSET

Mac takes out his tape recorder and records the distant winds.

Dallas looks over at the tall grass - and then walks over and begins to dig a hole.

He puts a weather device - along top.

In time Mac and him add a bird feeder - and a cable from the device - all the way to the kitchen window.

Mac looks over at the device - and then looks away.

SCENE 10 B: INT MAC AND DALLAS KITCHEN NIGHT

Mac and Dallas sit down to eat - and Dallas puts on the weather channel - and they watch the weather in the background. Dallas silently checks the device that accompanies the table - and a video feed and dashboard of content. Dallas watches. And then walks over and grabs a sheet of paper and a pen and begins to do math. Mac watches him in silent - and fiddles with his tape recorder.

V.O WEATHERMAN

> We are in for a wild ride - expect the unexpected - weather is unpredictable - yet here is the weather - > Good evening, folks. As we look ahead, we're in for quite a ride with the weather. Currently, the barometric pressure is dropping rapidly, indicating a significant storm system moving in from the southwest. Expect wind speeds to increase, reaching up to 60 miles per hour by midnight.

(MORE)

V.O WEATHERMAN (cont'd)

>

> The National Weather Service has issued a severe weather warning for the coastal areas, with a 70% chance of heavy rainfall, potentially accumulating up to 3 inches overnight. Temperatures will drop to the mid-40s, with a wind chill factor making it feel closer to the mid-30s.

>

> Satellite imagery shows a well-defined cold front approaching, which could lead to isolated thunderstorms. Residents are advised to secure outdoor items and prepare for possible power outages. Stay tuned for further updates as this system develops.

## SCENE 10 C: INT. MAC'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Mac goes to sleep and looks outside the window - as the weather and the storm approaches. Mac looks out his bedroom window. The fireflies are out again, their soft glow dotting the landscape. The wind rustles the tall grass outside, making the fireflies flicker and blur.

As Mac focuses on the distance, the fireflies' lights begin to resemble eyes watching from the darkness, unsettling him.

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## SCENE 11 : INT. MAC'S BEDROOM - MORNING

Mac looks in the morning and the earth is foggy but still - Mac peers out the window - nothing

## SCENE 11A : INT: DALLAS AND MAC KITCHEN - MORNING

Mac goes downstairs and Dallas is already up - and they eat breakfast - Dallas silently checks the device that accompanies the table - and a video feed and dashboard of content. Dallas watches. And then walks over and grabs a sheet of paper and a pen and begins to do math again. Mac watches him in silent - and puts the tape recorder in his backpack.

## SCENE 12: INT. DALLAS AND MAC CAR - MORNING

\_DALLAS\_ drive through town in their old sedan. The car's engine hums steadily as they approach the school. Mac sits quietly in the passenger seat, a mix of nervousness and anticipation on his face.

\_Mac\_ nods, gripping his backpack tightly as they pull up to the school.\_

## SCENE 13: EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT - BACK ENTRANCE - MORNING

\_Mac\_ steps out of the sedan, looking up at the imposing structure of his new school. The sounds of chattering students and the ringing of the school bell fill the air. \_Dallas\_ watches him from the car before driving off.

Off in the distance - Dominic drops off his Kids - Makayla, Asher, and Julie-Bee - who is accompanied by a hispanic aid.

## SCENE 14: INT. CLASSROOM - MORNING

\_Mac\_ enters the classroom, glancing around nervously at the unfamiliar faces. He finds an empty seat and sits down, trying to blend in.

The \_Mr. Foster\_, a man in his mid 30s, stands at the front of the room, beginning his introduction.

MR. FOSTER

> Hello everyone. Good morning,  
welcome - howdy - hello - hello  
everyone - all settled? Good - Hello  
class - I am Mr. David Allensworth  
Foster and I to you shall be referred  
to as Mr Foster - your 5th grade  
science teacher - - - this semester  
we will be exploring the wonders  
world of-weather patterns, the phases  
of the moon, and count all of the  
ripples of the tides... We'll then  
move on and examine different ways in  
which the phases of the moon rile  
together. In a chasm of solar  
gravity - moon beams. the tides work.

The teacher walks around - and grabs a globe off of the  
desk - and a little rocket ship - and then flies it around -  
and then walks over to another demonstration - of a  
miniature forest - inside of the forest there are these  
little acorn looking people helping plant the moss on the  
trees.

MR FOSTER

(continuing)

I hope you all enjoy the weather as  
much - and mysteries this world holds  
for those who dare brave enough to  
explore- to contact to touch

Mac listens intently, but his attention is soon drawn to  
the window. Outside, the sky is overcast, and a field of  
wetlands with tall grass stretches out beyond the  
schoolyard.\_

Asher looks as Mr Foster turns his back and secretly takes  
out a small camera and points it out towards the window. Mac  
also looks at towards the window to see what is going on..

SCENE 15: EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT - EARLY AFTERNOON

Mac sees ASHER (10) from afar, accompanied by MAKAYLA  
(12). In the distance - Mac sees Makayla hands Asher a  
bag, and Asher discreetly puts it in his backpack. Mac  
watches the exchange, his curiosity piqued.

As he watches the man - he turns and sees

Mac pretends to not have noticed but is clearly busted by Makayla.  
Dallas Arrives and Mac enters the car - clearly busted by Makayala.

SCENE 16: EXT. DALLAS AND MAC HOUSE - AFTERNOON

Dallas picks up Mac after school. As they drive home, they realize that Asher and MAKAYLA are their neighbors. The TALKATIVE NEIGHBOR from church approaches their car, greeting them enthusiastically.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

> My Lord hi yo look who it is -  
Dallas! Dallas - we're neighbors!

Makayla walks behind her father into frame and looks at Mac from afar.

Asher follows behind her sheepishly.

Makayala walks up to Mac and sticks out her hand.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Did you see me give Asher that bag?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

Yeah.

MAKAYLA

> You Did? Did you see what was  
inside it?

MAC

> Yeah.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

YEAH?

MAC

I didn't see what was inside.

Asher, looking sheepish, quickly walks Makayla approaches  
Mac, looking him up and down.\_

CUT TO DOMINIC

DOMINIC

My daughter has been into looking at  
owls - there are a ton among them -  
she thinks there creatures from  
another world - but I tell her there  
just owls Makayla - they re just  
owls. What does your son like to do?

DALLAS

Ah well - he's got this tape  
recorde...

DOMINIC

And the misses - where's the misses  
at?

DALLAS

She passed

DOMINIC

Oh - I'm sorry to hear that

DALLAS

Yeah

DOMINIC

Mine too you know

DALLAS

Really?

DOMINIC

Yeah... Yeah - yeah yeah yeah - it  
has been a while - - lets see -  
makayla is 12 - asher is 14 - - -  
julie bee - but she dont count -  
she's from my new wife - - - lets  
see - it has been 6 years - so yeah -  
makayla was a little - asher was 8 -  
asher a little slow so he don't talk  
too much - - anyway - how long it  
been for you

DALLAS  
It's been 3 years.

DOMINIC  
And its just you and the boy ?

DALLAS  
Yeah

A loud siren from far away - a horn. Dallas looks startled - it is an oddly deep like an organ but not as brassy - a calming tone -

DOMINIC  
Ah - don't worry about that - that's just for the fire - look did you know that they are - watch - 3 - 5 - - 7 - - that means there going to foster street new haven - - we're good out in branford - I guess something big is going on over there. You work out of New Haven yeah?

MAKAYLA  
You

\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*  
> Can I trust you?

\*\*MAC\*\*  
> Yeah.

\_Molly glances over at Dallas and to her father Dominic, then back to Mac.\_

\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*  
> Do you have a bike?

\_Mac\_ nods.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*** (cont'd)

> Good.

Macayla turns and walks away, disappearing into the distance behind her garage.\_

Mac looks over at his dad Dallas - who nods as Dominic continues - and he casually glances over at Asher - who casually glances over at him.

The two look at each other for a while - and then the wind moves one of the wind chimes - and then Mac takes out a little recorder out of his back pack Dominic - and then back to the retreating figure of Makayla.

Asher notices the tape recorder - and then looks over at Mac.

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> What is that?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> It's a tape recorder.

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> What does it do?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> It records the sounds of the world.

Makayla reemerges with a bike and Ashers bike.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> You guys ready? Dad - I'm going to show Mac the neighborhood.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

> Don't you be terrifyin those  
lizards again Makayla - -

**SCENE 17: EXT. THE HUNT - DAY 1 - DAYTIME**

Makayla opens up the bag, revealing crab meat and bits of chicken in some tiny zip locks. She hands some to Mac, along with sticks and string. The kids spend the night, trying to lure something out in the wetlands, but nothing happens. A thunderstorm begins to brew, and the wind howls around them.

Mac takes out his tape recorder and records the distant winds.

Makayla looks over at him - and then looks away.

Makayla walks over to a bag of lens on the ground - she looks at them.

**MAKAYLA**

Asher - what is this

**ASHER**

Be careful!

Asher runs over to the bag of lens and takes them away from Makayla.

**MAKAYLA**

You brought all of your toys here -  
where are the trail cams?

**ASHER**

Dad would be mad if we used those  
cameras. These are better trust me.

**MAC**

(to Asher)

What kind of lens are they?

**ASHER**

They're called prime lenses.

**MAKAYLA**

Asher - shut up - go home and get the  
gopro.

MAKAYLA (cont'd)

Mac - did you have much crab out in  
indiana?

SCENE 18: INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - NIGHT

Mac looks around his new room - and takes out and plays back the tape recorder - and then puts it away.

That night, Mac looks out his bedroom window. The thunderstorm rages outside, the wind shaking the trees and tall grass. The power flickers, then goes out. Mac stares into the darkness, his eyes wide as he hears a loud crash from outside.\\_

He presses his face closer to the glass, trying to make out what caused the noise, but all he can see are the blurred, glowing fireflies--now resembling eyes watching him through the storm.\_

FADE OUT.

# TUESDAY

## SCENE 19: EXT. HOUSE - TUESDAY MORNING

The morning sun casts long shadows as DALLAS steps outside, carrying a trash bag. He walks towards the bins, inspecting them for any sign of raccoons - he looks a bit puzzled at the far distance of the grasslands that surround their home.

In the distance, MAC (10) sprints towards the mailbox, eager to grab the mail. As he opens the mailbox, he notices something unusual: a small burn mark on the ground. It's not large or round, but scattered and irregular.

Dallas notices Mac's hesitation and walks over, peering down at the mark.\_

\_Dallas\_ frowns slightly but doesn't comment further. \_Mac\_ collects the mail, and they head to the car.

\_Mac\_ looks down - next to the lightning mark there is a single gemstone laying on the ground. \_Mac\_ doesn't touch it - but goes into the car.

## SCENE 20: INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

The classroom buzzes with chatter as the \_TEACHER\_ begins the day's lesson.

MR FOSTER  
Today's lesson is

> For those who were up last night, some of you may have the faint clap of a heard a distant rolling thunder - but what causes that? What causes these phonemeonms that allow us to get wild throughout the night?  
> \_The teacher throws a book on the ground\_

\*\*MR FOSTER\*\*

> I'm talking about boom thunder! And how long does thunder make a sound after lightning? Wake up people these are life long anecdotes! Today, we'll be learning about lightning forms-- phenomena that are particularly interesting here on the coast.

\ As the teacher continues, Mac glances across the room at ASHER (10). The two exchange knowing looks.

SCENE 21: EXT. SCHOOL YARD - AFTERNOON

School has just let out, and students are pouring out of the building. \_Mac\_ spots MAKAYLA (12) waiting near the edge of the playground. She walks up to him, a serious expression on her face.

MAKAYLA  
> Mac, Can I trust you?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Yeah.

\_Makayla looks around cautiously before speaking.\_

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Do you know about history - secret professors - tales of promises of the old? A long time ago, there was a group of professors who started absecret society - they were from Yale but they lived in Branford - okay - anyway - They would search these exact coasts - for specific crustaceans that they would find on specific rocks, during a certain time of the season, which is now.

**\*\*MAC\*\* (cont'd)**

> Why are you telling me this?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Because we have to be certain-- that we get the right bait.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Bait for what?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> The creature.

## **SCENE 22: EXT. CORNER BEACH - DUSK**

The golden light of the setting sun bathes the beach in a warm glow. \_Makayla, \_Asher, and \_Mac arrive with flashlights and ziplock bags.

They begin collecting small crustaceans from the rocks, carefully placing them in the bags with a bit of seawater.

\_Makayla\_ finds \_Mac\_ alone and begins to talk to him.

\_MAC\_ and \_MAKAYLA\_ sit on a driftwood log, the silence between them heavy. The distant sound of waves fills the air.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

\_(after a long silence)\_

> What happened to your mom?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

\_(speaking softly)\_

> She died a long time ago. She got sick when I was two... and died when I was three.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> That's cool - my mom too - \_(pause)\_ - so Why did you move here?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> My dad got a job at Yale.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Doing what?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I don't know - physics and nuclear stuff.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> He doesn't talk much does he.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> No

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> He see's things doesn't he? Things that arent there? - - you know my sister Julie-Bee sees things - but no one ever listens to her -

ASHER

Carmen does

MAKAYALA

Carmen treats her like a little stuffed animal Asher - grow up - we have to get her out of this - but for now its the situation - but little by little - as we learn through these creatures technology - we can

\_Mac doesn't respond - a long break.

The atmosphere is tense. Strange, wild sounds echo in the distance, like coyotes letting loose - and howling from far - and then close.\_

\*\*ASHER\*\*

> What was that?

The kids freeze, glancing around. MAKAYLA grabs out a small audio recorder that she has - and motions for the rest of the crew to stay silent - but after the second cry - without a word, they quickly gather their things and rush to their bikes.\_

## SCENE 23: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

\_Mac\_ pedals home as fast as he can, the events of the evening still fresh in his mind. When he arrives, he sees \_Dallas\_ outside, watching the bird feeder sway with the wind.

Without hesitation, \_Mac\_ runs to him and gives him a hug.

Dallas turns toward his son. And for a moment embrace - whilst doing so - they both hear the strange sound together--carried on the wind from the direction of the beach. Dallas looks out into the darkness, his concern growing.\\_

## SCENE 24: INT. MAC'S LIVINGROOM - NIGHT

Dallas and Mac sit down on their couch for dinner. Tension\_lingers, and they eat quietly. The distant sounds of the night mix with the clatter of utensils, adding to the growing sense of unease.

On the TV is the WEATHERMAN - talking about how some hurricane quickly making headway along the southern coast, and how it is hurricane season. He urges viewers to be on the lookout.

Dallas after dinner tells Mac he's going to go upstairs- Mac follows him up and goes into the little attic - Dallas is building lots of little bird feeders - he sands and shaves them down and puts them on the internet

# WEDNESDAY

## SCENE 25A EXT. OUTSIDE MORNING

Dallas and Mac walk the neighbor's dog but it isn't going well. They walk it by a patch of grass - tall grass - and Dallas looks off into the distance - Mac watches his gaze - and soon does the Dog - the latter too now staring at the great nothingness among the tall grass.

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## SCENE 25: EXT. DRIVEWAY - EVENING

DALLAS and MAC drive to a neighbor's house for dinner. The radio plays in the background.

\*\*RADIO ANNOUNCER (V.O.)\*\*

> And now for your evening weather forecast. Expect clear skies tonight with a slight breeze off the bay side. Perfect weather for the upcoming that Branford Sea Harvest Festival next week. Oh yeah - it should be good this year - get the kids - the get family - the whole family! Though right now the storm seems to be coming in - so you might want to stay indoors - but not too long - because the storm will pass and we should be good for the festival.

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## SCENE 26: INT. DOMINIC'S SCREENED BACKYARD DECK PARTY -  
EVENING

The setting sun bathes the backyard in a golden glow of  
fury. Laughter and sizzling sounds engulf the air as the  
neighbors mingle upon the backyard screened deck. DALLAS  
stands with DOMINIC, who's talking enthusiastically as he  
dips baby carrots into hummus and puts them on his plate.

Dominic gives Dallas and Mac the tour of the house - as he  
does - he points out a leaky roof.

DOMINIC  
Yeah yeah - we got some leaky roof  
aint nothing to it.

Makayla and Jocylen run by - ignoring Mac and headed  
straight for a little opening down the street.

DOMINIC (cont'd)  
(gesturing with a  
Fork full of ziti)\_

> Yeah, yeah, Hugo--my cousin--throws  
a big party every summer. You'd  
really like him-- he used to manage a  
cosignment store off in Branford but  
the owner died so he got into  
inflatable balloons - and was part of  
the team that brought the sea  
festival - so he throws these  
parties - for charity you kno - . You  
and your boy - what's his name?

### Cut To : Kids table:

\*\*Mac\*\*

> Mac

\*\*Jocylen\*\*

> Jocylen (beat) nice to meet you -  
my Mom said you and your Dad are from  
Minnesota? This is my brother Dylan

DYLAN  
Hello - nice to meet you.

\*\*Mac\*\*

> No - we were Monroe

\*\*Asher\*\*

> Is that in illonois?

\*\*Mac\*\*

> No it's part of Connecticut

\*\*Jocysten\*\*

> My mom said that your Dad and my dad work together

\*\*Mac\*\*

> Whose your dad?

\*\*Jocysten\*\*

> Rodney Roberts

\*\*Mac\*\*

> What does he do?

\*\*Jocysten\*\*

> He makes tools and stuff for the weather.

\*\*Makayla\*\*

> Your dad is absolute Legend - watch your mouth Jocysten

\*\*Mac\*\*

> Really?

\*\*Asher\*\*

> I like him

\*\*Makayla\*\*

> He invented the kaledoscope \\*\\*\\*\\*

\*\*Mac\*\*

> Where is he?

**\*\*Jocysten\*\***

> He moved to Florida - i'm here now  
with my mom and grandma.

**\*\*Mac\*\***

> How does my dad know him?

**\*\*Jocysten\*\***

> Not sure.

**\*\*Makayla\*\***

> My grandfather must know

**\*\*Asher\*\***

> We shouldn't wake him

### CUT TO:  
ADULTS TABLE

(\_(Dominic takes a  
bite of ziti, then  
continues)\_)

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

> My old man's old man - God rest his  
soul - used to tell me - Dominic -  
baby - get with the times - but he  
wasnt around much - and I worked the  
bars - I always respected what he did  
though - that with the weather - I  
mean, who knows when the next storm  
might hit. My old man is now here  
with us - but he don't talk much

\\_Dallas nods politely, but seems a bit overwhelmed by  
Dominic's energy. Mac stands nearby, quietly listening but  
not engaging, his eyes occasionally drifting to the edge of  
the backyard. In the far distance there appears to be an  
object

\\_MAKAYLA (12) approaches Dominic, hugging him quickly. She  
then steps back, looking over at Mac as she adjusts her  
backpack straps.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Dad, I'm heading to the back with the others. We'll be back in 20 minutes.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

> 20 minutes? What do you got to for 20 minutes? Makayla used to go and find squirrels and nurse them back to health - yep yeah - she still has those

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> I want to show them the fort

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

> Ooo the secret fort - - Makyala - when you going to show us the secret fort?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Yes, Dad.

\\_Makayla and the crew at the kids table - head toward the far end of the backyard. She disappears into the twilight, silhouetted against the setting sun.

\\_Dallas watches them leave, as if sensing something in the air, but doesn't say anything. Dominic resumes the animated conversation.

---

**## SCENE 27: EXT. MAKAYLA'S SECRET LAIR - LATE AFTERNOON**

The deck party continues in the distance. Mac wanders alone near the far end of Makayla's backyard, which stretches to the edge of the coast.

Mac stands still, staring at the water. Waves crash against the rocks. He scans the grass, looking for mysterious eyes, then back to Makayla.

Suddenly, a faint whimper--like an animal in pain--echoes from the wilderness. Nautical sounds engulf him, heightening his fear. The grass rustles, but it's unclear if it's wind or something else.

Frightened, Mac steps back, ready to return to the party. But before he can leave, the kids table emerges from the fog--Makayla, Asher, and Joculen. They move purposefully, faces serious.

\\_Makayla steps forward, focusing on Mac.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

\\_(firm, yet urgent)\\_

> Mac, give me that shovel.

\\_Mac hesitates, then nods and grabs a nearby shovel. As he hands it over, Makayla turns to the group, her expression shifting to leadership.\\_

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> You there Mac, Mac?

\\_Asher takes a short breath and grasps his shovel. He begins to dig and dig and dig - almost in anger - almost too fast.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Relax baby brother

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> What is he digging for?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> He's not digging FOR anything

> Alright. The best thing we could probably do is rub our faces with mud - it hides our scents.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> What is going on?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> There is something out there - and I am going to make contact with it.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> What do you mean?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> What are you going to say?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> What do you say to a group of photons who are distangled from eachother?

**\*\*Julie Been\*\***

> what are they saying

Makayla and Asher look at each other. Makayla continues to gear up.

**\*\*MAKAYALA\*\***

> I am not sure.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Well, what does it look like?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Well, there is more than one type - so far in this part of the region - they are part of a subsect - they are phsyical - real - things that can tackle you -

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> They are also small.

**\*\*JULIE BEEN\*\***

> Tiny

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> You guys still claim that - there is no evidence of that - we have no relationship to this.

The kids, led by Makayla, move deeper into the tall grass, toward the tallest grass where the coast drops off into the sea. The fog thickens, and the air grows colder.

---

**## Scene 28: EXT. THE EDGE OF THE TALL GRASS THICKET**

The crew hang around the tall grass as time moves slowly agaিসnt the wind - agaিসnt the branches of the tall grass.

\ Makayla takes out a pack of hotdogs from Asher's backpack cōoler and cleans it on a flat rock - Mac grabs the the shovel leaning agaিসnt the outer wall of the wigwam - and Asher slowly brings the baitfish over and puts it in the bucket.

**\*\*JOCYLEN\*\***

> Makayla this is crazy

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Yeah - you think?

**\*\*JOCYLEN\*\***

> Makayla

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> What's crazy about it?

**\*\*JOCYLEN\*\***

> Huh?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> You said this was crazy - what's crazy about it - Mac get the shovel and dig a hole by the edge of the lawn - we call that the outpost - we're going to plant another camera - Asher - get the rope swing pulley and string the bags of bait. - - See what we do is tie these bad boys to that tree there - and let them swing -

**\*\*JOCYLEN\*\***

> How do we know this isn't just some racoon getting its kicks oabout it?

\\_Mac and \\_Asher diligently set up cameras on the surrounding trees - they hook cables up to a battery pack taped onto a wooden panel.

**## SCENE 29: EXT. MAKAYLA'S HIDEAWAY - LATE AFTERNOON**

\\_The kids gather at their hideaway--a makeshift wigwam - fort hidden deep in Makayla's backyard old playground set - grass. Inside, houses a rudimentary surveillance system: several portable HDMI Monitors - run by a batterypank tied to a solar panel. Shovels and buckets and poles are propped up against rocks and driftwood, their screens glowing in the dim light. Cables stretch out towards to a jury-rigged power supply--a large battery bank cobbled together from old car batteries and solar chargers.

\\_ASHER fiddles with the wiring as he ensures each screen is properly connected. Makayla walks over and sits down in front of the monitors. Asher, Mac, and Jocylen behind her.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> The creatures are likely to come out tonight - the tide.

\\_Mac looks out the cracks of the makeshift wigwam - through it he watches the tallgrass swaying in the wind.

**\*\*JOCYLEN\*\***

> How do you know that?

\\_They exchange glances.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> What creatures?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

\\_(setting up a camera)\\_

> The wind will pick up and push the smell out -

**\*\*JOCYLEN\*\***

> Out where?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> Out there.

Asher tests the camera pan into the Tall Grass

\\_Makayla watches Asher set up the final camera.

**## SCENE 30 - BACK AT THE WIGWAM HQ**

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Asher, the feed isn't working.

\\_Asher leans over, squinting at the screen.

\\_He scrolls through the tiny menu of the cheap digital camera, but the screen remains locked in the wrong shutter speed.

**\*\*Makayla\*\***

> Just turn the night vision on - we can fix it on computer

\\_Mac watches Makayla - and off in the distance - he hears a little noise - that it seems like only he could hear - he looks out the at the darkening sky, a hint of worry in his voice.

**\*\*Makayla\*\***

> Mac what is it?

\\_Makayla looks torn, glancing between the malfunctioning equipment and her friends.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> But we haven't got the camera working yet. Haaaaaa - okay - I guess we have enough cameras - Asher go and record - make sure you are saving it as an mp4.

They like blackberries - did you know that?

**\*\*JOCYLEN\*\***

\\_(standing up)\\_

> Makayla we ought to go back - its been more than 20 min

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Go then Jocylen - we are right in the backyard - tell them we're fine - but go if you need to - go go go go go.

\\_Jocylen leaves the wigwam...

**\*\*CUT TO: EXT. DOMINICS'S BACKYARD - NIGHT\*\***

\\_Reluctantly, they begin to gather their things. Makayla lingers, staring out at the tall grass with a mix of disappointment and determination.

\\_As they pack up their makeshift surveillance system, the wind picks up, rustling through the grass. For a moment, it almost sounds like whispers carried on the breeze.

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<!-- END of 25-30 -->

<!-- START OF 31 -->

**## Scene 31: INT. DOMINICS BACK DECK - EARLY EVENING**

\_The kids return to the party. Mac approaches Dallas, who's standing alone in the hallway, looking at wall-mounted family portraits--photos of when the kids were little. He looks at his son and smiles.\_

**\*\*Dominic\*\***

> Where were you guys?

**\*\*Makayla\*\***

> We were out in the backyard

**\*\*Dominic\*\***

> You out there cookin Lizards - you better watch yourself Makayla (jokin) I'm joking kid relax - (to Dallas) I gotta check that the girl - i vote yes for bush craft - but got to make sure she aint doing witch craft.

\_Bonnie comes out with a big mashed potato plate of mashed potatoes.

**\*\*Dominic\*\***

> Alright - let's go - it's time for dinner.

**## Scene 32 - EXT. BEACHSIDE NEIGHBORHOOD- SUNSET**

**\*\*\_[Traveling Montage]\_\*\***

Dallas and Mac walk home - the pair gently stroll through the windy sunset and watch all of the docks dance upon the ocean - they walk towards the edge of mansions - towards the sidewalks - towards the tallgrass.

As they walk adjacent to the tall grass - Mac begins to notice some movement in the far distance. Dallas stops - and for a moment the two begin to listen. Silence.

**## SCENE 32a - EXT. BEACHSIDE NEIGHBORHOOD - SUNSET**

They continue their walk.

As they walk into their driveway - they notice a howl in the distance followed by a series of howls and howls and slow whimpers. They go inside.

**## Scene 33 - INT. MAC'S KITCHEN - NIGHT**

Mac and Dallas get ready for bed - Dallas checks upon his project on the table - and mac goes and looks at a spindel of a paper towel holder - which he holds up to the light - Dallas notices him looking at it - and then goes back to his own creation.

**\*\*Mac\*\***

> Do you think this could be used as a tripod?

**\*\*Dallas\*\***

> A tripod for what

**\*\*Mac\*\***

> Makayla wants to build a radar system - so she wants to mount something

**\*\*Dallas\*\***

> That wont be able to hold the weight

Mac puts a couple of ojects on the edges

**\*\*Mac\*\***

> But it can stand the wind. Do you think its possible for for animals to give off distinct radiation?

**## Scene 33a- INT. MAC'S BEDROOM - NIGHT**

Mac looks outside his window and sees a disturbance in the tall grass. In the distance a small light glows and flickers. Mac takes a little flash light and flickers back - and the light goes out. And then it doesn't go on again.

**# THURSDAY  
MORNING**

**## SCENE 34: INT. HOUSE - MORNING**

Dallas begins to go inside, the sound of the breeze from the Long Island Sound rustling through the trees. He pauses, looking out at the sky before stepping through the door. From the corner of his eye - he spots an oject by the mailbox but he doesn't go up to it.

Mac goes and begins to record the sounds through his tape recorder.

## SCENE 34a - INT CAR

Dallas drives Mac to school.

## Scene 35: INT. CLASSROOM - MORNING

The class mid-session - Mac looks out the window in the distance and sees another weather reporter taking footage of some bush behind a chain linked fence across the street. The cameraman is pointing to something on the ground.

The teacher an elderly woman - asks the class a question - and Mac is the first to answer.

**\*\*MR. FOSTER\*\***

> Light gives us an alert - in the 1980s it was the - the man from the funeral home and the scientist have the same fate. But that is not this class -

> Mac - what have you learned about the weather so far this year?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> There are a bunch of things - we live in an atmosphere - and the atmosphere is made up of a bunch of different things - and the weather is what happens when the atmosphere changes. Different things happen when the atmosphere changes. Animals and plants and things act differently when the atmosphere changes. And we can predict the weather - but we can't predict everything.

**\*\*Teacher\*\***

> Okay Mac - I see you.

**\*\*Teacher\*\***

> Asher

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> Yeah?

**\*\*Teacher\*\***

> What do you think about the weather?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> I like it.

**\*\*Teacher\*\***

> What makes you say that?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> I don't know - I just like it.

**\*\*Teacher\*\***

> Can you elaborate?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> I don't know - I just like it.

---

**## SCENE 36: EXT. CHURCH PARKING LOT**

The crew gather around outside of youth group parking lot playground - there parents drop them off and they meet with Pastor Jerry outside and sit in a circle of chairs outside -

The group sit around in a circle and play basic board games - and getting to know you ice breakers.

**\*\*JERRY\*\***

> Let's go around and see where we  
are all from

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Did you guys hear the coyotes last  
night?

**\*\*JERRY\*\***

> How many do you think there were?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Dozens

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\* (cont'd)**

> Pastor Jerry - have you noticed  
what is going on with the Weather?

After the class, the Youth Pastor notices Mac sitting  
alone and goes over to console him.

---

**## SCENE 37: EXT. CHURCH PARKING LOT**

Mac sits alone on the picnic table near the parking lot as  
the rest of the crew's parents pack up. Jerry helps by  
folding the chairs and asks for a hand.

The Youth Pastor notices Mac sitting alone and joins him  
on the stoop.

**\*\*JERRY\*\***

> Mac, you seem deep in thought over  
there.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Yeah - no - I'm just waiting.

**\*\*JERRY\*\***

> Is your Dad coming to pick you up?

**MAC**

> Yeah - He should be here soon. He's  
sometimes late.d

JERRY

> That's okay - - - First week - new town - new school - new youth group - new haven - you guys live in new haven?

\*\*MAC\*\*

> No - we live closer to Branford .

\*\*JERRY\*\*

> How did you father find this church?

\*\*MAC\*\*

> he works at Yale

> Ah - that's good...

\*\*JERRY\*\* (CONT'D)

> Yeah - I remember coming here from Georgia - wasn't used to these New England winters. But that was a while ago.

\_Mac continues to look onward.\_

\*\*MAC\*\*

> Can you keep a secret? stories?

\*\*JERRY\*\*

> Well, I

\*\*MAC\*\*

> What about creatures?

\*\*JERRY\*\*

> What do you mean?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Do you think there are creatures in other worlds?

**\*\*JERRY\*\***

> What's that?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> The handout you gave before - and the talk after - you said that the  
\*\_ came from \*\_ to serve God.

**\*\*JERRY\*\***

> I did - yes.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> So are there still creatures in this world?

**\*\*JERRY\*\***

> Hmmm. Well, maybe you could think of the creatures of the deep waters that we're still figuring out.  
> (MORE)

**\*\*JERRY\*\* (CONT'D)**

> I think it's easy for us to get hung up on the logistics - - but if you think about it there are still - - ancient things - things we don't understand - we're discovering about dinosaurs and whatnot.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

**\*\*MAC\*\*** (cont'd)

> That's not what I mean. Makayla was talking about these creatures that she has been seeing in the tall grass - and now her and Asher and me are taking pictures of the tall grass. And the other day - I really could have sworn - that I saw one outside my window.

\\_Dallas parks outside - and Mac shakes Jerry's hand.

Dallas gives an apologetic wave - thank you

**\*\*DALLAS\*\***

> Sorry I was late - thank you -

Mac walks into the car and looks off in the distance of a small object on the side of the road far off in the distance.\_

[MONTAGE OF  
DRIVING FROM  
THE HAVENS TO  
BRANFORD]

ENE 38: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - EVENING

Dallas grills outside - - Dallas grilling. The smoke from the grill rises and catches the light, casting eerie shadows. Mac looks beyond the borders of their property, his gaze fixated on the tall grass swaying in the breeze. Mac takes out his recorder and

Dallas walks over to the contraption he has been building - now all built up

Birds are acting weird - a group of birds gathers but then falls apart - and then all swarms around one area above the tall grass

\_Dallas\_ notices him staring and follows his gaze, looking at the tall grass as well.d

SCENE 40: INT. MAC'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Dallas and Mac eat dinner. walks back inside to find \_Dallas\_ staring at the weather TV - and then Dallas grabs his device again . \_Dallas\_ notices \_Mac\_ and gets up. The two sit together by the TV. Off in the distance - the wind pulls up.

Dallas walks over to the bird house not complete or built - and he looks down somberly over it. Mac goes over to the piano and plays a little rift as he records it in his tape recorder - as the wind picks up outside.

## SCENE 41: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

That night, as they prepare for bed, a strange sound echoes through the house. The wind begins to pick up, rattling the windows. \_Dallas\_ looks out into the night, the tall grass swaying ominously.

---

## SCENE 42: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

\_Dallas\_ steps outside into the thunderstorm to make sure everything is secure. The wind howls around him as he checks the perimeter, a sense of unease settling in.

Mac Joins him.

The two far in the distance - hear the birds but they do not see them - the tall trees cast shadows beneath the tall grass

And tiny - but tiny little glowing lights 2 green and 3 red below - and then two big purple type eyes that glow blue - little blue lights - and then a bit of a mist -

Fire flies

Mac does his best to go back inside to get his tape recorder.

## SCENE 42a : : :

::

\\*\\* THE BIG ENCOUNTER

Mac goes outside and takes out the trash - he notices a dead bird - and then from the far he sees three little stones placed near his mail box. Circular smooth stones

Mac walks over and sees a little figure - but as he looks it is just some twine. As he examines the tall grass with a flash light - he notices some horrid looking shadows in the far distance and quickly closes his sack up and goes up

SCENE 42a: INT. MAC'S BEDROOM - DARK NIGHT

Mac stares outside the window outside on the tall grass

\*\*FADE OUT.\*\*

# FRIDAY

SCENE 43: INT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING

The next morning, the storm has passed, but the air is foggy - the street lights are still on - creating a golden hue of shadow amid the rainy street. heavy with the remnants of the previous night's events. DALLAS looks out the window and finds the seed from the bird feeder scattered about. MAC searches for the rocks they had collected earlier.

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## SCENE 44: INT. SCHOOL CLASSROOM - DAY

The TEACHER stands at the front of the class, addressing the students.

MR FOSTER

MR FOSTER (cont'd)

What a busy week we have had class no? What a busy week indeed - Mr Mac - who is new in town - is welcomed with a wild display of nature's glory. Not sure if you folks have been noticing, but the weather has been acting sporadic lately. A little weird - a little odd - like something doesn't seem right - Sporadic - the sporadic nature of nature - - what does the word sporadic mean? Let us find out.

SCENE 45: INT. SCHOOL MEDIA LAB - AFTERNOON

The crew-- MAKAYLA, MAC, and a few other kids--gather around a computer. They stand over a software editor, DaVinci Resolve, going frame by frame through various camera footage, scanning for any sign of eyes or other mysterious figures. MISTY hands MAKAYLA another camera, and she inserts its SD card into the computer.

Nothing unusual comes up on the screen.

MAKAYLA

What Mac saw last night - the cameras must have picked up somehow - - see if we can go and saturate the colors some how

MISTY

I think I am doing it

MAKAYLA

Yeah yeah - that's right - good Misty good - that looks better - - look - look right there

Mac and Asher move closer to the computer screen - above the three little stones is a little fog in the lens.

MAKAYLA (cont'd)

Zoom in on that

ASHER

What is that?

MAKAYLA

It has to be one of the creatures -  
they congregate on the pebbles - it  
serves as a beacon for them

MISTY

What are you talking about? It's just  
a lens flair

MAKAYLA

Mac - call your dad

MAC

We have that bbq picnic tonight

MAKAYLA

Crap that's right.

ASHER

It's out by the docks though -

s

SCENE 46 : EXT: BBQ OUTSIDE SEASIDE DOCK - EVENING SUNSET

The place is buzzing at the docks - the sunset is beautiful.  
And the atmosphere of Stony Creek is off the charts## Scene  
82 : EXT. MAC and DALLAS HOUSE

The crew goes wild with their bikes down the road, past the  
post office, riding along the tiny coastal sidewalks. The  
wind whips through their hair as they pedal furiously, their  
laughter carried away by the sea breeze.

The crew ride there bikes - Makayla and Mac ride together in  
the collaborative bike - and Asher rides along side them  
along the school yard and begin to go and go and go until  
they get to the edge of the beach spot

# SATURDAY #2

SCENE 47: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING

DALLAS is outside, focused on building a bird feeder but  
he can't seem to get it working.

He watches the way that the reflection of the glass holding the seed reflects off of it - and how it goes into the garage.

Dallas goes back and finds a little mirror to add -

He examines his creation, a little then turns his attention to a bucket filled with gardening supplies. Initially hesitant, he eventually begins tending to the garden.

\_MAC\_ rummages through the bucket, discovering an old fishing wire and a ring. He fashions a makeshift ring toss game on a tree across from the tall grass.

\_Mac\_ plays for a while, then retrieves his bike and rides off.

**SCENE 48: EXT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE - MORNING**

\_Mac\_ parks his bike outside Makayla and Asher's home.  
\_DOMINIC\_, the talkative neighbor, answers the door.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

Oh, what's up Mr. Mac - what's shaking my friend? How's your Dad doing?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

He's okay.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

What's he up to these days?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

Works mostly

DOMINIC

Tell him to come over sometime - I got a new air fryer and . You looking for Makayla?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

Yea.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

> Makaylaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa. Mac's here. Come downstairs.

ASHER

Hey mac.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

That's right - you guys are in the same class - how's Mr Roberts this year?

MAC

You know him?

DOMINIC

Of course - he was my homeroom teacher - he was a young man back then - and for the most part still a young man - right Asher haaaa

Makayla comes running upstairs from the den to the Kitchen - with camcorders, and various electronic equipment in hand she .

#### **SCENE 49: INT. MAKAYLA'S DEN STUDY - DAY**

The guest room room is cluttered with bookcases of equipment that look like it should belong on a shelf at the good will. and VHS - radios and dials - but beyond it lies a little beads that hang from the wall - as they enter between the dishwasher and the single cement window lays Makayla's inner headquarters. - She turns on a feed and it shows the remote locations outside - the feed shows the wigwam. covers, playhouses, and dust-covered blankets concealing books and chests. Makayla, Mac, and Asher huddle around a dusty laptop with basic movie editing software.

There is a washer and dryer and various other household items.

ASHER

Makayla we better be clean or Dad is going to be upset.

MAKAYLA

He's downstairs dealing with Julie-Lee and Carmen's speeding ticket.

Makayla opens

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

**\_(whispering)\_**

> I was thinking we could triangulate  
the places where we had our  
encounters and make a map - find a  
pattern and start to track.

Makayla fires open a rediumnetary (sic) paint program on her  
computer.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Mac... Mac

**\*\*Mac\*\***

> Yeah?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Can I trust you?

Makayla retrieves an old, leather-bound journal from a  
shelf. She begins reading aloud from an entry dated 1925,  
describing her grandfather's encounter with strange  
creatures in the woods.

Inside the book there are various drawings of the  
creatures - Mac's eyes grow wide.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

**\_(reading)\_**

> "Wednesday - 79 degree  
farhienhite - 1925 - wind gust  
averages \ \ \ - outside - near the  
coast - far off in the distance I  
stood with my father - and we both  
saw the stones..."

As Makayla continues reading, the wind outside picks up.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\* (cont'd)**

**\_(determined,  
closing the  
journal)\_**

> We have to find out what happened  
next. If Grandpa saw them, then we  
can too.

(MORE)

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*** (cont'd)

We just need to figure out what they want... before it's too late. I think they want the chicken on the stick.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I think I should go home.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> What do you mean?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> It's getting windy.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I don't feel good.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Don't lie to me Mac.

The two look at each other for a good while.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*** (cont'd)

> Don't ever lie to me.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Okay - I want to go home because I don't think it is a good idea that we summon these creatures...

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> You really think that?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> What do you mean?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Is that the real reason why you  
want to go home?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> Makayla - stop

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I want to see my dad.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> What do you think he's doing right  
now?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> Makayla...

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I'm out of here.

\ Mac gets up and walks out the door and grabs his bike and  
rides home.

**## SCENE 50: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

Mac rides his bike home alone among the tall grass.

---

**\*\*MAC\*\***

Okay - when do you want to do this?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

We have to wait on the weather - for a true thunderstorm.

**MAC**

I think that the creatures are real  
and just not yet discovered -

MAKAYLA

What do you think they are?

MAC

But then we forget.

MAKAYLA

We can never tell anyone about this.  
I thought about of - but I don't  
think we should capture it anymore.

The winds crash against the shoreline.

SCENE 51: EXT. MAC'S BIKE RIDE HOME

Mac rides his bike along the tall grass, scanning for eyes. He notices a dog in the distance acting strangely, barking at the tall grass. Mac speeds up.

## SCENE 52: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - OUTSIDE GARAGE

Mac finds Dallas outside taking weather measurements. Dallas explains how it works.

In the distance, a camera crew is filming something in the tall grass. Mac, curious, walks over to investigate. He spots another gemstone on the ground but doesn't touch it.

SCENE 53: INT. MAC'S HOUSE - DINNER TIME

Mac and Dallas eat dinner while watching TV. News reports discuss the approaching hurricane and "hurricane season."

Mac looks out the window, searching for eyes in the tall grass. He sees a flicker in the night.

That night, as the wind howls, Mac's gaze wanders across the street to the tall grass.

SCENE 54: INT. CHURCH SANCTUARY

The church is buzzing with talk of the town - apparently a very strange event happened to everything the night before.

\_Mac\_ looks at different congregates hovering around a coffee pot as an older gentleman hands out welcome cards. On the screen there are announcements for the upcoming Harvest Festival - the church is going to be a part of it and run the kids crafts table - volunteers are needed.

\_Mac\_ and \_Dallas\_ walk into the pew and sit behind a baby that stares at Mac.

The piano begins.

**\*\*PASTOR JERRY\*\***

Please find a seat - our call to worship this morning is from the book of Isaiah - Chapter 52 verse 25.

\_The projector screen displays the verse.\_

\_Mac\_ looks around for \_Makayla\_ and \_Asher\_ but they are not here this morning.

An elderly woman approaches Dallas and Mac - and asks Mac if we could

#### SCENE 55: EXT. CHURCH OUTSIDE FELLOWSHIP LUNCH

\_Mac\_ approaches \_Jerry\_ and asks him if he has seen \_Makayla\_ or \_Asher\_.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

I was with them yesterday.

**\*\*PASTOR JERRY\*\***

They were supposed to help out with the nursery room - all good - just not like their father to not bring them - okay - sorry - just wanted to make sure they were okay.

#### ## SCENE 56: EXT. BEACH HOUSE

\_Mac\_ and \_Dallas\_ approach their home from their walk.  
\_Mac\_ runs over to the mailbox.

\_Mac\_ looks around the neighbors' house but sees their car gone.

SCENE 57: INT. SCHOOL

\_Mac\_ checks the stones - they are still there. School begins and ends. The teacher talks about the weather more. Asher and Mac eat silently during lunch. \_Makayla's\_ dominating picks them all up.

Outside Makayla's house there is the news crew.

Asher takes special interest

Mac\_ goes home that night and sees \_Makayla\_ sitting alone.

SCENE 58: EXT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

I can't believe that what we are seeing is real.

\_Mac's eyes widen.\_

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

It came.

\_Mac's eyes widen again.\_

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Really?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> We were going to get the footage before it got dark - and as we were approaching the camera - He saw the creature too and he ran away and he broke his leg - I stood there and stood still... we were there until late - and I was tired so I asked my dad if I could stay home from school today and he said it was okay - he took off work himself - Asher's in the hospital and we're going to go over after we shower and visit him - he should be back tomorrow.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Have you talked to him?

**\*\*MAC\*\*** (cont'd)

> No - not really - I told him not to talk about what we were doing back there - as the adults would think would get all worried and start a big investigation and ruin our plans before they begin.

**\*\*MAC\*\*** (cont'd)

> What do you see?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> I saw eyes in the distance... And then - and then I don't know what happened - it was like - I was dreaming for a second - but then I woke up and it was gone - and Asher was crying in the distance.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Did you look at the footage?

(Makayla Smiles.)

**\*\*CUT TO\*\***

The footage is profound - and the kids are excited - it shows a creature - and then a flash of light - and then nothing - and then Asher crying - but a flash of light - and in the center as they zoom nothing - but as a filter is applied - some makeshift eyes appear.

**## SCENE 59: INT. MAKAYLA'S COMPUTER ROOM**

The Hispanic aid helps Julie-Bee

The crew look at a series of old CRT era laptops all haphazardly and hackerdly arranged - and then a big slow motion - and then nothing - and then Asher crying - but a flash of light - and in the center as they zoom nothing - but as a filter is applied - some makeshift eyes appear.

The Dominic comes downstairs and tells Makayla that they have to go - Mac needs to go home.\_

DOMINIC

Mac - you have to go home - we're  
about to have dinner - are you  
staying for dinner? If not - go to  
get the hell out

\*\*CUT TO\*\*

## SCENE 60: EXT. MAC HOUSE - EVENING

Dallas is out in the front yard looking at the smooth  
stones scattered on the outside of his wall. He takes out a  
little hankerchief and grabs one and holds it closer to his  
face.

Mac walks behind him - ready for school and then he looks  
at Mac - Mac looks back - the two walk inside and check  
the weather.

# TUESDAY #2

## SCENE 61: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING

School has been cancelled. DALLAS turns on the TV.

\*\*TV ANNOUNCER (V.O.)\*\*

Due to the impending hurricane, all  
schools in the area will be closed  
today. The storm is expected to make  
landfall...

MAC looks out the window, seeing a bright sunny sky.  
MAKAYLA and ASHER arrive on bikes.

\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*

Can we use your sink?

## SCENE 62: INT. MAC'S KITCHEN

Dominic and his family are there -

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

Thank you for letting us use your -  
the power keeps going out on our  
house. Here

sink. And for the overall  
hospitality my friend - we got a  
leaky roof - shelter.

Dominic begins handing dallas a suitcase full of supplies -  
battery chargers - and what not - crackers - bottles of  
water - bottles of seltzer.

Behind him - Makayla comes in with her own suitcase - and  
Asher comes in with his own - and Julie Bee - and the  
hispanic aid also come in - and all set up shop in the  
living room - Makayla watches the crowd gather and instead  
goes and

DALLAS stands over the sink, washing dirt off potatoes. He  
moves aside as MAKAYLA storms in.\_

MAKAYLA takes out an old metal instrument and begins  
washing dirt off of it.\_

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

( (rattling on) )  
I have a plan. I think the creatures  
have landed. I believe they've come  
with the storm. Now, we're going to  
mark them.

DALLAS putters around, looking for a towel to dry his  
hands.\_

MAKAYLA hands MAC the wet instrument. DALLAS hands MAC a  
cloth.\_

MAKAYLA and DALLAS lock eyes. ASHER bumps into them,  
carrying a box of meat thermometers.\_

**## SCENE 63: EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD**

MAKAYLA demonstrates to MAC, ASHER, and DALLAS how to plant  
a device in the ground.\_

\*\*MAKAYLA (V.O.)\*\*  
Creatures, like animals, give off  
heat... These are set to pick up  
temperature changes in the ground.

\_MAKAYLA pulls out an electrical device. DALLAS picks it up,  
inspecting it.\_

                  \*\*ASHER\*\*  
Does it work?

\_DALLAS looks concerned, takes it to his workshop.\_

                  \*\*MAKAYLA\*\*  
He's going to fix it, right? I think  
that one works. He'll figure it out.  
Here's another.  
                  (\_(tosses a trail cam  
                  to MAC)\_)  
It's a trail cam. When we get notice  
of ground temperature changes, we'll  
know when to look for footage. Grade  
A stuff - they detect night vision  
and anything else. And then - we are  
going to - remotely - communicate via  
flash light - with mirrors

                  \*\*MAC\*\*  
Where do you want to hang them?

SCENE 64: EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD - THE TREE

\_MAC uses his fishing line kit to tie down a device.\_

Makayla runs out of the kitchen and everyone tries to get  
her to stay - but she is determined. And escapes - she runs  
away through the tall grass.

SCENE 65: EXT. MAKAYLA BACKYARD

\_MAC hangs another deer cam. ASHER plants meat thermometers  
near the tall grass and arranges his tripods.

**\*\*MAKAYLA (V.O.)\*\***

The creatures give off heat - just  
like any other creatures.  
What we are going to is start to make  
a pattern of light - and mirrors

Off in the distance - Domonic looks off in the distance as  
he waters his plants and shakes his head.

SCENE 65A: EXT. NEIGHBORHOOD - LATE AFTERNOON

The kids ride bikes. MAKAYLA scouts locations. ASHER and  
MAC ride together.\_

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

Do you think there are really  
creatures in the tall grass?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

(\_(Looking at Asher)\_)  
Do you?\_

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

I think so. Makayla seems to think  
so, at least.

Makayla and the gang add little tiny baits on hooks and then  
Asher frames little trail cams on selfie sticks that they  
plant in the grass

## SCENE 66: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - DUSK

The children arrive. DALLAS comes out with the fixed  
device, handing it to MAKAYLA. They exchange looks. MAKAYLA  
and ASHER ride off.\_

MAC and DALLAS go inside silently. DALLAS resumes washing  
potatoes.\_

SCENE 67: INT. MAC AND DALLAS' LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Dallas sits on the couch sad - and he looks at the object in front of him. The winds howl outside - but he just feels so sad.

## SCENE 68: INT. MAC'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

MAC stares at glow-in-the-dark stars on his ceiling, then at a picture of his mom on the dresser.

A faint cry, like a wounded animal, is heard in the distance, then stops.

MAC looks out the window at the tall grass. He sees nothing.

Mac gets up and takes his little tape recorder off at first, then spots eyes.

Mac retreats to bed, then looks out again. Nothing.

Another cry is heard, followed by a loud crash and then nothing - and then a little whimper - like a small animal is dying.

MAC stands at his bedroom window, peering out into the darkness. The moonlight casts eerie shadows across the backyard.

His eyes scan the dark horizon, searching. For the briefest moment, GLOWING EYES appear between the swaying grass. MAC's breath catches in his throat. He blinks, and the eyes are gone. Was it real, or just his imagination?

Another faint cry echoes in the distance, sending a shiver down MAC's spine. He leans closer to the window, pressing his forehead against the cool glass.

Suddenly, the motion-activated porch light flicks on, startling MAC. He sees DALLAS step out onto the porch, looking around with a concerned expression.

MAC quickly ducks away from the window, his heart racing. He climbs back into bed, pulling the covers up to his chin. As he lies there in the dark, he can't shake the feeling that something out there is watching them.

SCENE 69: INT. MAC'S KITCHEN - NIGHT

Mac stares out his window - and looks outside the tall grass - he goes outside a bit - and approaches it.

Mac makes a decision - to go outside - he goes and straps his tape recorder around his neck and musters up the courage to open the kitchen screened door

Mac musters up the courage and leaves his bedroom to head outside.

SCENE 70 : EXT. TALL GRASS - MAC'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

As Mac approaches the tall grass and gets closer - he sees the creature and its light flickers in the tall grass - it comes to the edge of the grass - and appears from far away - it is small in size and appears quiet friendly - though Mac really make out what it is.

Nervously - Mac enters the tall grass - towards the shattering light - through the wind - and it pauses - as he approaches it the light shines upon his face - blinding him temporarily - but then settling down - into a small silhouette of a creature hovering above a tiny stone - Mac makes eye contact with the creature - and then the creature gets off the stone and begins to walk on top of the grass floor.

Nervously - he records the tape recorder - but soon - the creature goes back into the tall grass - it is a little rainbow looking ball of light.

Mac looks at the stones in the ground - and nervously - takes out his camera phone but the phone is dead - and he tries to record the tape - but the tape is speeding up faster and faster - and suddenly pops out - the creature is short in nature - and about no larger than a water bottle. It looks at Mac - frozen - and mac looks back at it.

Mac bends down - almost in a trance - and finds his fear turns towards curiosity.

Mac holds out his finger - and the creature backs away - and then gazes away from Mac - behind him in the tall grass.

The creature is still about 10 feet away - and Mac still can't make out - but it seems friendly.

It all disappears and Mac quietly walks back to home and goes to bed - a bit shocked.

#### SCENE 71: INT. SCHOOL CLASSROOM - MORNING

Mac is shocked - quiet at breakfast - quiet during the car ride - quiet on the way up the stairs - quiet in the class - with the substitute teacher

The classroom is unusually quiet as Mac and Asher walk in. They notice a stranger standing at the front of the room, a SUBSTITUTE TEACHER, who is fumbling with the attendance sheet.\_

MR SULLIVAN  
(\_(nervously)\_)

> Good morning, class. I'm Mr. Sullivan, and I'll be your substitute teacher today. Mr. Foster is out sick - and I'm here to help out with the lesson plan. Let's see what we got here.

The students exchange curious glances. Mac and Asher take their seats, whispering to each other.\_

The substitute teacher clears his throat, trying to gain the class's attention.\_

SUBSTITUTE TEACHER

SUBSTITUTE TEACHER (cont'd)  
> Alright, let's get started. Today,  
we'll be continuing with your weather  
patterns lesson.

\_Mac and Asher exchange a look.\_

All of a sudden loud sirens go off in the school - and  
another teacher comes inside.

OTHER TEACHER  
Class - due to the weather conditions  
we are going to be cancelling today's  
after school event

The class

CUT TO

SCENE 72: EXT. NEIGHBORHOOD - DAY

Makayla and the crew ride their bikes home among the  
nature - among the wind - among the tall grass. Mac rides in  
Makayala's spare wagon - and feels a bit spacey - peaceful  
but a bit dazed - as if he cannot stop looking out on the  
tall grass - even though it terrifies him so

SCENE 73: INT. MAKAYALA'S KITCHEN - EARLY AFTERNOON

Dominic comes downstairs from his home office.

DOMINIC  
What are you kids doing? Mac - nice  
to see you - Misty - good to see  
you - you kids hungry? Why are you  
not in school

ASHER  
The weather

DOMINIC  
What weather

Dominic puts his head outside but sees nothing.

MAKAYLA

If what you are saying is right -  
they are connected to the smooth  
stones - which makes sense - that the  
spirit world often will tie physical  
objects

MISTY

I thought you said that these  
creatures are physical and not orbs  
or spirits

MAKAYLA

Yeah Misty well facts have change d-  
and it makes sense if you think about  
it

JULIE-BEE

We not care about the how.

The gang is around the computers in the media center - as  
the rest of the building watches the news - and sirens go  
off.

Makayla looks at the GPS of Mac's backyard.

The school is buzzing with the news of the creatures. The  
kids are whispering and pointing at Mac and Dallas as they  
enter.

\_Mac\_ and \_Dallas\_ sit at a table with \_Makayla\_ and  
\_Asher\_.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> They're going to come back again -  
Mac saw the stones again this morning

MISTY

Did you Mac?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I know.

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> We're going to be stuck in this  
metal box with a bunch of dead  
batteries.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> What?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> The thermometers - they're dead.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I know.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

We're going to be stuck in this metal box with a bunch of dead batteries.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I know.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> It has to be tonight.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> I know.

The basement house is filled with the sound of the storm approaching. The wind howls outside as Makayla arrives, carrying a backpack full of supplies. She knocks on the door, and Asher quickly lets her in.\_

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> Did you bring everything?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Yeah, it's all here. We need to set up the trap before it gets any worse out there.

SCENE 74: EXT. THE 23RD ANNUAL SEA FESTIVAL

\_They move to the living room, where they spread out the contents of Makayla's backpack: ropes, stakes, and a few homemade devices.\_

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

I thought they canceled school?

**DOMINIC**

They did - but that was there  
choice - this is our choice - we're  
going to this festival to support  
your cousin eddie. Julie Bee is going  
to stay here with Carmensita and  
that's it.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> It has to. We don't have any other  
choice.

They work quickly, setting up the trap near the back door.  
The wind outside grows stronger, rattling the windows.\_

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> What if the storm gets too bad?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Then we'll have to be extra  
careful. But we can't wait any  
longer. The creatures are coming, and  
we need to be ready.

Asher nods, determination in his eyes. They finish setting  
up the trap and double-check everything.\_

Dallas steps outside, noticing the kids setting up the  
traps. He watches them for a moment, then silently  
approaches, his presence unnoticed at first.\_

Asher and Makayla are focused on their task, unaware of Dallas's approach. He quietly picks up a stake and a rope, examining their setup.\_

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*** (cont'd)

> Make sure the ropes are tight. We can't afford any mistakes.

Asher nods, tightening a knot. Dallas steps in, securing another stake into the ground with practiced ease. The kids look up, surprised to see him there.\_

As the wind howls louder, Dallas checks the stability of their setup, making sure everything is in place. He hands Makayla a rope, and she ties it down, her confidence growing with his support.\_

The kids nod, their resolve strengthened by his presence. As the storm continues to rage, they prepare to face the creatures, knowing they have Dallas's silent support.\_

SCENE 75: EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

The storm approaches

The house is dark and Mac and Dallas have dinner. Mac begins to talk about the creatures.\_

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Dad... Do you think that the storm will hit us?

**\*\*DALLAS\*\***

> It could be.

MAC

I miss mom.

DALLAS

Me too.

MAC

Dad... Have you seen the eyes?

\_Dallas pauses, his expression serious. He looks at Mac, considering his words carefully.\_

\*\*DALLAS\*\*

I have.

\_Mac's eyes widen, a mix of fear and curiosity.\_

\_Mac nods, feeling a sense of reassurance from his father's words. The bond between them strengthens as they prepare for the unknown.\_

\*\*CUT TO\*\*

SCENE 76: INT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Dallas and Mac go into overdrive mode - preparing the house. They board up the windows and cover all necessary areas.

Dominic prepares some mashed potatoes and stew for the whole family.

Makayla in Mac's room getting impatient - but Asher is admiring all of Mac's collectibles and what not.

\*\*TV REPORTER (V.O.)\*\*

> Evacuations are underway in the area - but are limited in scope focusing on the northern regions - for the southern regions - it is advise that people stay in their homes and board up any long - head for a basement.

Mac and Dallas sit in the living room as Dominic makes a dinner in there kitchen. Julie Bee cries a bit and the spanish maid has to go . casting shadows on their faces. Suddenly, Mac's phone rings. He looks at the screen and sees it's a FaceTime call from Makayla.

Asher makes mac and cheese - Makayla looks around and laughs to herself.

MAKAYALA

You know when I was younger I used to watch this woman who would take pictures of these lights -

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

Mac?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> Makayla?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> We're ready. If they are going to be there again - now is the time - we do not have much time.

MAC

I don't think they'll be out there - and it is getting kind of windy - aren't you afraid?

As Dallas and Mac watch the tv - Dallas watches Mac get up the couch and follow Makayla and Asher into their kitchen - Dallas sits alone for a while - and then makes a decision to go follow them.

**## SCENE 77 : EXT. EDGE OF MAC'S BACKYARD**

Asher sets up the tripods and the cameras and points out the window - and he aims the cameras. Mac also sets up his tape recorder next to him.

Makayla and Mac and Dallas and Asher all rush to the center of the tall grass - as they do horrific sounds are heard.

## SCENE 78 : EXT. OUTSIDE THE ALL GRASS - NIGHT

The creatures and the children make contact with each other - and there are creatures of dark figures all around them too - but the creatures are soft with the children and are delighted by the gifts that they offer -

They show this by hovering over the meat and dancing among them - in a big orchestra of light and sound around them.

It is like the wind - like the whisper - and like the wonder - and through the vision the children see flowers and peace and growth and wonder through the light - and then a gated wall - and far off in the distance - darkness over a forest - and microorganisms growing - growing into metal - into steel - and into objects of despair.

## SCENE 79: EXT. INSIDE TALL GRASS

As the children go inside the world they begin to see that the world is much like they're own - and they're true home and yet they see all the loved ones back home - they see the hurricane coming from a distance and the creatures in the tall grass - bring them back to the tall grass - and do dances around the bottom floor -

The creatures all hover around the little stones - and the stones point up at the weather and separate the clouds.

Mac Makayla Asher and Dallas are frozen in this tundra of light.

Suddenly a dark creature is surrounding them all.

The winds pick up - the hurricane looms closer

## SCENE 80:

The cat like creature - shadows and hangs over the children and Dallas and the creature on the floor from a branch nearby - - interlude of the creature is so vast - it has wingspan and it comes down and goes for the throat of one of the soft small creature and goes for the neck - and Makayla tries to get a stick to swat it away - but the creature grabs the stick - and Dallas - looks at the creature and grabs it - Mac and Asher stand paralyzed with fear - the dark winged creatures grow in length - eventually covering the entire treescape - and the howls that they emit are so devastating

The winds pick up

## ## SCENE 81

The good little creatures come out of the wood work - and begin to help their fallen friend - they arise and begin to climb and make music together that tears the dark creatures into sparks and particles that blow into the wind and the storm - and the little creatures - are hurt - and the hurricane winds pick up - and they begin to float away - as their little bodies are light as feathers - and they begin to cry - and as they cry a cone of light emits from their head - much like a projector - that of flowers and of winds - and of mystics

They go on the little stones - and do a little dance - and little by little the weather begins to get better. And everyone just watches.

## ## SCENE 82:

Mac has an encounter with the creature as it bleeds to death and as the light begins to fade - as the other creatures begin to cry - the dying little creature tells Mac a story in his mind

## Creature ##

> There was peace once and there will be peace again - but not in this world - not in this world -

## ## SCENE 83:

Weather report  
Clouds are good back to normal

Makayla and Mac sit on a log - and

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Did you get any of that on tape?

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> No - I don't think so

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> The creature sang with me a song -  
and was the reason why the hurricane  
broke up you know.  
I think we need to plant something.

**\*\*Makayla\*\***

> What do you mean?

MAKAYLA

I'm scared.

MAC

Really?

MAKAYLA

Yeah.

MAC

Then why are you hunting these  
creatures?

MAKAYLA

Because I don't think they're any  
different than animals - real  
physical animals - not aliens - or  
interdimensional beings - I think  
they are flesh and blood and live in  
the arth - and if they got found  
out - the lawyers of the town. And  
the truth is - you saw them - your  
dad saw them - and now we have to  
capture it on film.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> I know.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

MAKAYLA (cont'd)

> We need to do that again. At first I thought this was all just a way to get proof that there is something in that tall grass - but now that we have seen the creatures - I think we need to take it a step further - we got to communicate with them - they were obviously trying to communicate with us - and I think we need to do that again - I think they need our help.

## SCENE 84 : EXT. MAC AND DALLAS HOUSE

Makayla and Asher arrive via bike.

Makayla and Mac Meet Jocylen and Asher and Dallas and they all go to the church.

\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*

> My theory is simple - the creatures are trying to communicate with us - that we must protect that piece of land out in the back of Mac's house. Now the way we can do that - it seemed like they liked the little berries more than they liked the meat.

\*\*MAC\*\*

> I don't think that's what they were trying to tell us

Dallas goes outside and is working

\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*

> So what say you?

\*\*MAC\*\*

> I don't think we do anything.

\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*

> Asher - what say you?

\*\*ASHER\*\*

> I don't know.

\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*

> Well - we got to do something.

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> I think we were just all dreaming.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> What do you mean we were just all dreaming? How is that possible?

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\*** (cont'd)

> Well, let's just go back to the spot and look about.

**## SCENE 85:**

Mac's backyard by the tall grass. The crew is examining the tall grass. Asher is setting up his camera and tripod.

Mac is a bit nervous as he looks at the tall grass and begins to pant. His ears begin to ring and his head begins to spin. Makayla and Asher grab him and bring him out of the tall grass.

Mac looks up at the sky and the weather is getting stormy again.

**\*\*MAC\*\***

> We got to stop - this is none of our business - we ought not do what we did - and we ought to go back to the house and forget about it.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> What is making you say that? Did that thing get into your mind?

**\*\*ASHER\*\***

> It would have had to been the dark one.

Suddenly a dark creature goes and swoops in and continues to kill the little creature on the floor.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

(off in the distance)

> Makayla Asher - come here.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> Dad we have to go.

**\*\*DOMINIC\*\***

> What is your definition of grounded  
Makayla - - last night you ran into  
the storm - and we had to chase  
after - poor Dallas had to go out in  
the rain.

Dallas sits at the table and looks at the kids.

**\*\*Dominic\*\***

> Say you are sorry to Mr. Dallas.

**\*\*MAKAYLA\*\***

> I'm sorry Mr. Dallas - I won't do  
it again.

SCENE 86: EXT. CURCH OUTSIDE - DAY

Church BBQ is buzzing.

Mac tells Makayla and the gang what the creature told them

## Scene 84: INT. MAKAYLA'S BACKYARD

The the crew gather around and look at footage

## Scene 85:

Seaside festival the cameras pick up something wild - and  
animals start to act funky. As they drive down the street -  
As Dallas and Mac wander the streets - the tall grass  
whimpers in the distancel.

## SCENE 87:

The children plant the thing the creature told them to  
plant - a seed a beacon of hope - a symbol of a gift - of a  
time for peace - a remembrance - of time for peace.

And as the statue remains there - time passes - and people age and the hurricane season never really

VO WEATHERMAN

The Hurrican looms closer - it is  
adsided that the

The kids all gather around the spot again - but this time they appear closer to the tall grass - for they go in Mac's backyard and it seems as if that everything has disappeared.

Then Asher begins to get a headache and drops to the ground - he says that they have moved closer to the edge - because the dark creatures do not like the water.

So they are going to regroup by the water and give us a final message.

MAKAYLA

How do you know that?

ASHER

It was just a voice inside my head -  
it was the creature - it's friendly.  
It wants us to go now - right this  
moment.

#### SCENE 89 - EXT: NEIGHBORHOOD SUNSET MONTAGE

The kids ride bikes through the wind and the rain and they get to the edge - there is no sign of them - but by the tunes they wait - and they look at the corners of the dunes and nothing is there.

MAKAYLA

Maybe we should put something down  
for bait.

ASHER

They don't want bait anymore.

The crew waits from a distance from a little hollowed

#### # SCENE 90 - EXT. BEACH TRAIL TALL GRASS

Makayla and Mac wait on the trail - and as they talk - in the distance they seem like the

From the corner of their eye - and from their great surprise they see another creature.

MAC

Why do you think this is all happening?

MAKAYLA

You tell me - you are the

Asher sets up one of his tripods. Mac sets up one of his tape recorders - but the winds howls and dark whispers appear past the mountain by the tall grass.

MAKAYLA (cont'd)

My grandfather saw this once.

In the distance more howls - and Makayala and Mac turn around to see the creature limping ever so slightly - it falls to the sand - and its little blood begins to bleed on the sand.

Makayla rushes over to the creature - which looks more like a squirrel if anything else - but it is bright green around its eyes - as if painted as a tropical bird - or much like soft gleams of yellow gradients into green - it bleeds - and in its little hand is a little stone.

As Makayla approaches it - a dark figure shadow figure goes and swoops up the creature and takes it far into the sky.

As it drifts in the distance it looks like a giant seagull - but it is hard to see via the clouds and the distance.

# SCENE 91 - EXT - ENCOUNTER

A more direction confrontation with the creatures. One of the creatures is seriously injured and is limping on the ground - Makayla takes out supplies out of her backpack - the same thing that she uses for the squirrels.

# SCENE 92 -

## SCENE 93: INT. DALLAS KITCHEN

Dallas looks at the device as the kids wander about.

The scene opens in the quiet, dimly lit kitchen of Dallas's house. The storm outside has settled into a steady rhythm, with rain tapping against the windows and distant thunder rumbling. Dallas is seated at the kitchen table, a weather device in front of him. Its blinking lights and faint beeping add an ambient tension to the room. He's focused, meticulously adjusting knobs and checking readings on the dashboard. His face is lined with both concentration and unease.

Scene 94: EXT. Film Screening

The kids watch a film screening of the footage they have made. But

Scene 94a: EXT: Bon Fire - Morning

The kids light a bon fire and put all of the film down in it

Scene 94: EXT. MAKAYALA'S DRIVEWAY

There is a bbq - and the kids gather around the kids table - as Dominic introduces Dallas to a shy lady - Mac looks back at Dallas and then at Makayla and then at Asher and then at the tall grass out in the distance.

He takes out his little whistle and begins to play his tune - as if he is entering a littlet rance like state

At a church basement - a new family comes in.

They get all jazzed up about the tale.

FADE TO BLACK.